

5.5 Surface Integrals

Motivation:

In section 5.2.1 we discussed the idea that a line integral was useful for adding up a quantity over a given curve C . In this section we wish to extend this idea to adding up a quantity over a given *surface* σ to create the idea of a surface integral.

This idea can be useful in a variety of applications

- Adding up charge across a magnetized surface.
- Adding up gravitational forces across a surface.
- Adding up the density across a surface to help find the mass of the surface.
- Adding up flow of fluid through σ to help find the total quantity of fluid flowing through σ .

So, how do we construct an integral that will do this?

Exploration: Suppose we have a smooth surface σ that we plan to move across, and we want to add up the quantity at each point given by the function $f(x, y, z)$. Let Q represent the total quantity over the surface. How do we find Q ?

We can begin by partition σ up into n patches.

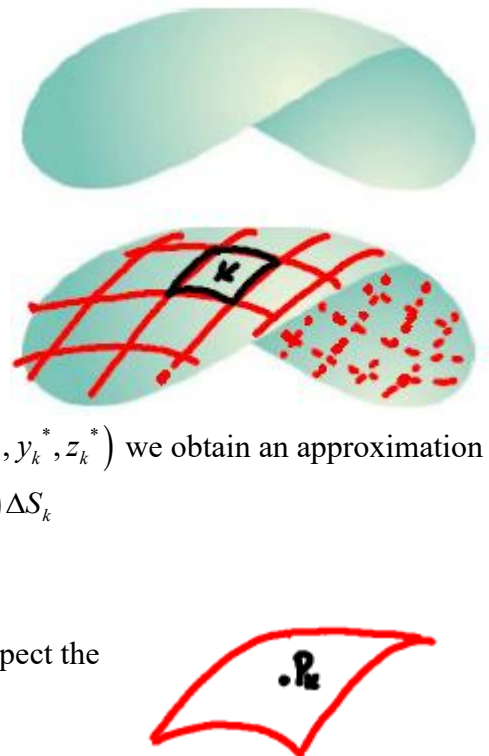
Consider the k^{th} patch and choose a representative point $P_k(x_k^*, y_k^*, z_k^*)$ for this patch.

If we let ΔS_k represent the surface area of this patch and Q_k represent the quantity that exists over this patch. If we measure function f at $P_k(x_k^*, y_k^*, z_k^*)$ we obtain an approximation of the quantity we are adding up over this patch to be $Q_k \approx f(x_k^*, y_k^*, z_k^*) \Delta S_k$

Therefore, $Q \approx \sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*, y_k^*, z_k^*) \Delta S_k$ and as n approaches infinity we suspect the approximation to approach the correct value.

Therefore, we have $Q = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*, y_k^*, z_k^*) \Delta S_k = \iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS$

This leads us to the following definition.



Definition: Assuming that f is continuous, the surface integral of f over the surface σ is $\iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS$.

Remark: Let $\mathbf{r}(u, v) = x(u, v)\mathbf{i} + y(u, v)\mathbf{j} + z(u, v)\mathbf{k}$ be the parameterization of the surface σ . We saw in section 4.4 that the surface area of the k^{th} patch, ΔS_k , is approximated by $\Delta S_k \approx \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| dA$.

Therefore, we can rewrite the previous definition as follows.

Definition (Updated): Assuming that f is continuous, the surface integral of f over the surface σ is

$$\iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS = \iint_D f(\mathbf{r}(u, v)) \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| dA.$$

Remark: Note that if $f(x, y, z) = 1$, then the surface integral $\iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS$ becomes $\iint_{\sigma} dS = \iint_D \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| dA$ which we know from section 4.4 yields the surface area of σ .

Example 1: Consider the surface $\sigma = \{(x, y, z) \mid y = 2x^2 + 1, 0 \leq x \leq 2, 4 \leq z \leq 8\}$.

a) Find a parameterization $\mathbf{r}(u, v)$ for σ .

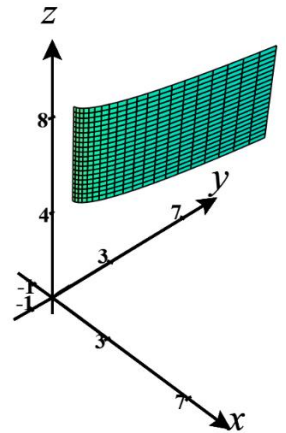
A parameterization for σ is $\mathbf{r}(u, v) = \langle u, 2u^2 + 1, v \rangle$ where $0 \leq u \leq 2, 4 \leq v \leq 8$.

b) Evaluate $\iint_{\sigma} (xz^2) dS$.

We note that $\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v = \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ 1 & 4u & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = \langle 4u, -1, 0 \rangle$. Then, $\|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| = \sqrt{16u^2 + 1}$, and we

have that

$$\begin{aligned} \iint_{\sigma} (xz^2) dS &= \int_4^8 \int_0^2 uv^2 \sqrt{16u^2 + 1} du dv = \int_4^8 \left[\left(\frac{1}{48} (16u^2 + 1)^{\frac{3}{2}} \right) \right]_{u=0}^{u=2} v^2 dv \\ &= \int_4^8 \frac{65\sqrt{65} - 1}{48} v^2 dv = \frac{65\sqrt{65} - 1}{144} v^3 \Big|_4^8 \\ &= \frac{28}{9} (65\sqrt{65} - 1). \end{aligned}$$



Example 2: Compute the surface integral $\iint_{\sigma} z^2 dS$ where σ is the unit sphere $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 1$.

Hint: Use what you know about spherical coordinates to find parametric equations for σ .

Parametric equations for σ are:

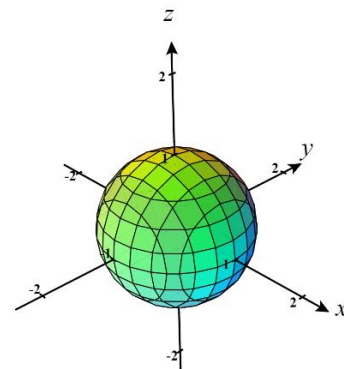
$$x = \sin(\phi)\cos(\theta) \quad y = \sin(\phi)\sin(\theta) \quad z = \cos(\phi) \quad \text{where } 0 \leq \phi \leq \pi, \quad 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi.$$

If we replace ϕ with u and θ with v we can parameterize the surface as

$$\mathbf{r}(u, v) = \langle \sin(u)\cos(v), \sin(u)\sin(v), \cos(u) \rangle \quad \text{where } 0 \leq u \leq \pi, \quad 0 \leq v \leq 2\pi.$$

Note that you don't have to replace ϕ with u and θ with v and then get

$$\mathbf{r}(\phi, \theta) = \langle \sin(\phi)\cos(\theta), \sin(\phi)\sin(\theta), \cos(\phi) \rangle \quad \text{where } 0 \leq \phi \leq \pi, \quad 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi.$$



In order to set up the surface integral as an iterated integral we need to know $\|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\|$. So, we calculate that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v &= \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ \cos(u)\cos(v) & \cos(u)\sin(v) & -\sin(u) \\ -\sin(u)\sin(v) & \sin(u)\cos(v) & 0 \end{vmatrix} \\ &= \langle \sin^2(u)\cos(v), \sin^2(u)\sin(v), \cos(u)\sin(u)\cos^2(v) + \cos(u)\sin(u)\sin^2(v) \rangle \\ &= \langle \sin^2(u)\cos(v), \sin^2(u)\sin(v), \cos(u)\sin(u) \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Then,

$$\begin{aligned} \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| &= \sqrt{\sin^4(u)\cos^2(v) + \sin^4(u)\sin^2(v) + \sin^2(u)\cos^2(u)} \\ &= \sqrt{\sin^4(u) + \sin^2(u)\cos^2(u)} = \sqrt{\sin^2(u)(\sin^2(u) + \cos^2(u))} = |\sin(u)|. \end{aligned}$$

Since we know that $0 \leq u \leq \pi$, we have that $|\sin(u)| = \sin(u)$.

Now, we have that $\iint_{\sigma} z^2 dS = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{\pi} (\cos(v))^2 \sin(u) du dv = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{\pi} \sin(u) \cos^2(u) du dv$. If we let $k = \cos(u)$, then

we note that $dk = -\sin(u)du \Rightarrow -dk = \sin(u)du$, $k(0) = 1$, and $k(\pi) = -1$. This means

$$\begin{aligned} &\int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{\pi} \sin(u) \cos^2(u) du dv \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \int_1^{-1} -k^2 dk dv = \int_0^{2\pi} \left[-\frac{k^3}{3} \right]_{k=1}^{k=-1} dv \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \left(\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{3} \right) dv = \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{2}{3} dv = \frac{2}{3} (2\pi) = \frac{4\pi}{3}. \end{aligned}$$

Example 3: Suppose σ is a smooth surface given by $z = g(x, y)$ where $(x, y) \in D$. Express the surface integral $\iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS$ as a double integral in terms of x and y .

Using a technique from section 4.4, we know that a parameterization for σ is: $\mathbf{r}(u, v) = \langle u, v, g(u, v) \rangle$ where u and v satisfy the same conditions as x and y . We can therefore rewrite this parameterization as:

$\mathbf{r}(x, y) = \langle x, y, g(x, y) \rangle$. By definition we know that $\iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS = \iint_D f(x, y, g(x, y)) \|\mathbf{r}_x \times \mathbf{r}_y\| dA$.

We now have written the surface integral as a double integral in terms of x and y , but we will simplify the double integral a bit further. Note that $\mathbf{r}_x = \langle 1, 0, g_x(x, y) \rangle$ and $\mathbf{r}_y = \langle 0, 1, g_y(x, y) \rangle$. This implies that

$$\mathbf{r}_x \times \mathbf{r}_y = \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ 1 & 0 & g_x(x, y) \\ 0 & 1 & g_y(x, y) \end{vmatrix} = \langle -g_x(x, y), -g_y(x, y), 1 \rangle \quad \text{and} \quad \|\mathbf{r}_x \times \mathbf{r}_y\| = \sqrt{(g_x(x, y))^2 + (g_y(x, y))^2 + 1}.$$

$$\text{So, } \iint_D f(x, y, g(x, y)) \|\mathbf{r}_x \times \mathbf{r}_y\| dA = \iint_D \left[f(x, y, g(x, y)) \sqrt{(g_x(x, y))^2 + (g_y(x, y))^2 + 1} \right] dA.$$

Note: In this example we are assuming that f is continuous on σ . Oftentimes this condition is just assumed without being stated in the textbook.

The most recent example is the justification for the following formulas.

Formulas: Suppose σ is a smooth surface given by $z = g(x, y)$ where $(x, y) \in D$. Then,

1. A normal vector to the surface at $(x, y, g(x, y))$ is $\langle -g_x(x, y), -g_y(x, y), 1 \rangle$.

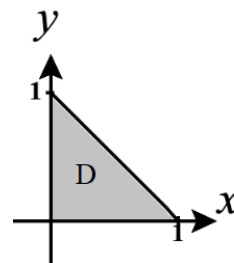
$$2. \quad \iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS = \iint_D \left[f(x, y, g(x, y)) \sqrt{\left(\frac{\partial z}{\partial x}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{\partial z}{\partial y}\right)^2 + 1} \right] dA$$

Note: It is possible to derive similar formulas in the cases where the surface is given by $y = h(x, z)$ or when the surface is given by $x = j(y, z)$. Can you guess what the formulas would be in these cases? See page 1133 of the book for one of the formulas.

Example 4: Fully setup, but do not evaluate, the surface integral $\iint_{\sigma} 2 \cos(y)(z - \tan(y) + 1) dS$ where σ is the portion of the surface $z = \tan(y)$ which exists over the triangular region with endpoints $(0,0)$, $(1,0)$, & $(0,1)$.

We first note that the region D has the following picture and can be defined as $D = \{(x, y) | 0 \leq x \leq 1 \text{ \& } 0 \leq y \leq 1 - x\}$ know that

$$\begin{aligned} \iint_{\sigma} 2 \cos(y)(z - \tan(y) + 1) dS &= \iint_D 2 \cos(y)(\tan(y) - \tan(y) + 1) \sqrt{(0)^2 + \sec^2(y) + 1} dA \\ &= \int_0^1 \int_0^{1-x} 2 \cos(y) \sqrt{\sec^2(y) + 1} dy dx \end{aligned}$$



We now state a fact which we will recognize as an extension of a property of line integrals.

Fact: If σ is a finite union of smooth surfaces: $\sigma_1, \sigma_2, \dots, \sigma_n$ (we say σ is piecewise-smooth), then

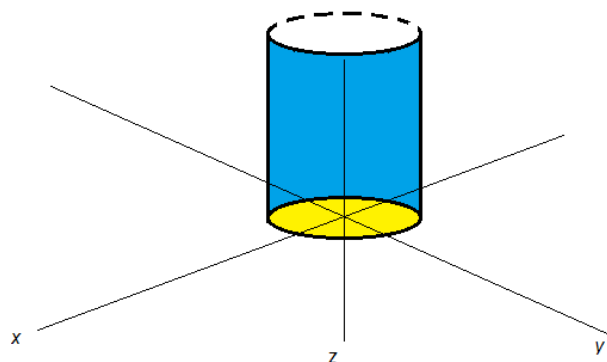
$$\iint_{\sigma} f(x, y, z) dS = \iint_{\sigma_1} f(x, y, z) dS + \iint_{\sigma_2} f(x, y, z) dS + \dots + \iint_{\sigma_n} f(x, y, z) dS.$$

Example 5: Suppose that σ is the “can without a top” which consists of $\sigma_1 = \{(x, y, z) | x^2 + y^2 = 1, 0 \leq z \leq 2\}$ and $\sigma_2 = \{(x, y, z) | x^2 + y^2 \leq 1, z = 0\}$.

a) Find a parameterization $\mathbf{r}(u, v)$ of σ_1 .

First, a picture of the surface with σ_1 in blue and σ_2 in yellow is:

Using the idea of cylindrical coordinates an answer is:
 $\mathbf{r}(u, v) = \langle \cos(u), \sin(u), v \rangle$ where $0 \leq u \leq 2\pi$ and $0 \leq v \leq 2$.



b) Find a parameterization $\mathbf{s}(u, v)$ of σ_2 .

Using the idea of polar coordinates, an answer is: $\mathbf{s}(u, v) = \langle v \cos(u), v \sin(u), 0 \rangle$ where $0 \leq u \leq 2\pi$ and $0 \leq v \leq 1$.

c) Evaluate $\iint_{\sigma} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2) dS$.

Using the most recent fact, we have that:

$$\begin{aligned} \iint_{\sigma} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2) dS &= \iint_{\sigma_1} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2) dS + \iint_{\sigma_2} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2) dS \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^2 (\cos^2(u) + \sin^2(u) + v^2) \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| dv du + \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^1 (v^2 \cos^2(u) + v^2 \sin^2(u)) \|\mathbf{s}_u \times \mathbf{s}_v\| dv du \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^2 (1 + v^2) \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| dv du + \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^1 (v^2) \|\mathbf{s}_u \times \mathbf{s}_v\| dv du. \end{aligned}$$

So, we calculate: $\|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| = \left\| \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ -\sin(u) & \cos(u) & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{vmatrix} \right\| = \|\langle \cos(u), \sin(u), 0 \rangle\| = 1$ and

$$\|\mathbf{s}_u \times \mathbf{s}_v\| = \left\| \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ -v \sin(u) & v \cos(u) & 0 \\ \cos(u) & \sin(u) & 0 \end{vmatrix} \right\| = \|\langle 0, 0, -v \rangle\| = v.$$

We are now able to calculate the answer:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^2 (1 + v^2) \|\mathbf{r}_u \times \mathbf{r}_v\| dv du + \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^1 (v^2) \|\mathbf{s}_u \times \mathbf{s}_v\| dv du &= \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^2 (1 + v^2) dv du + \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^1 (v^3) dv du \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \left(v + \frac{v^3}{3} \right) \Big|_{v=0}^{v=2} du + \int_0^{2\pi} \left(\frac{v^4}{4} \right) \Big|_{v=0}^{v=1} du = \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{14}{3} du + \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{1}{4} du = 2\pi \left(\frac{14}{3} + \frac{1}{4} \right) = 2\pi \left(\frac{59}{12} \right) = \frac{59\pi}{6}. \end{aligned}$$

d) Note that σ_2 didn't *need* to be parameterized and could have just been expressed as the surface in the form of $z = f(x, y)$ over a region D . Find the surface integral for σ_2 using this approach.

We see that if σ_2 is written as $z = 0$ over a region D , then we define $D = \{(r, \theta) | 0 \leq r \leq 1 \text{ \& } 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi\}$.

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} \iint_{\sigma_2} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2) dS &= \iint_D (x^2 + y^2 + (0)^2) \sqrt{(0)^2 + (0)^2 + 1} dA = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^1 r^2 \sqrt{1} r dr d\theta \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^1 r^3 dr d\theta = \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{1}{4} d\theta = \frac{\pi}{2} \end{aligned}$$